39 An unstable nucleus of an element decays by emitting an α-particle or a β^- particle to become a nucleus of a different element. This nucleus is also unstable and emits an α-particle or a β^- particle. The process continues until an isotope of the original element is produced.

What is the minimum possible number of these particles emitted?

A 2 **B** 3 **C** 4 **D** 5